Notion - Zotero Integration

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Overview of the technology stack for this project

Zotero - Reference Management Tool picture of desktop app?

Notion - Note taking and Project Management Tool

Notero - Integration Tool

Zapier - an Additional Integration Tool

Why Integrate Zotero with Notion via Notero?

Open Sourced - allows for continuous community contributions and developmental transparency

Centralized reference and knowledge management

Improved workflow for academic research or project management

Real-time sync across multiple collaborators

Allows for annotations in the PDFs to uploaded along with paper

Metadata automatically populated and transferred

Integrate Zotero with Notion (prototype)

Goal: Create infrastructure that allows Seanomers to share and discuss papers.

Start

Drag a PDF of a paper onto the Zotero app.

- It should automatically retrieve the metadata and upload everything to the Notion DB that Olga setup SN Papers. WHOO!
- All you have to do is download the app and sign in. No need to download Notero.

Issues

- There is no backwards compatibility from Notion --> Zotero
  - There may not initially be a need for this, but somewhere down the line when it is being used frequently, people might find cases where this is convenient. This may require going back which could be avoidable.
  - I am on track to solving this, see ZAP section.

Notero updates Notion

- Plugin uploads everything to the Notion DB that Olga setup SN Papers.
- We will eventually transition the Notero account to Olga.
  - If only one person in a group has Notero setup, Zotero considers this "centralized" and doesn't require group members to sign up and download Notero.
  - If two people download and login to Notero, it's "decentralized" and everyone has to download it.

Paper has been uploaded to Notion

In SN Papers! Along with Metadata

Issues

- When uploading the file, the Table in Notion will put "Notero" under the "Created by" column. It's annoying if you want to speak with whoever uploaded a paper and you have no idea.
- This seems to be unavoidable bc it is built into Notion. Below is a screenshot from Notion.
- Make a separate column in SN Papers called "Uploaded by." Problem is, people have to remember to update it and it kind of makes the whole point of the program moot to have people navigate to the page anyways. Temporary solution.
- Currently thinking a ZAP could take care of this ^.

zapier

Edits made in Notion are transferred to Zotero through a ZAP (This step is not necessary)

Issues

- Right now it seems like everyone will have to integrate this ZAP for it to be functional. I don't love that. Will discuss with Olga.
  - The ZAP is fully functional though

Overview:

How does setting up Notero work?

Screenshots of setting up the integration:

Connecting Zotero collections with Notion databases

Permissions and access control (API keys, integration setup)

Walkthrough of current syncing capabilities:

Adding PDFs and references to Zotero → automatic sync to Notion

Editing metadata in Zotero → updates in Notion

Common Use Cases

- Journal Club
- Collaboration
- Project Documentation (resources)
- Managing Citations
- Add more!

Challenges and (Current) Limitations

- Uploading a paper to Zotero leads to the column in the SN Paper Library to say uploaded by “Notero” instead of the user. This is hardwired into Notion.
- There is no backwards compatibility for edits made in Notion to show up in Zotero.
- Lots of metadata is being uploaded (show picture) but it would be useful to upload tags too
- Please don’t hesitate to reach out to me if you have an idea! I welcome it.

Troubleshooting and Common Issues

- Occasional sync delay - manual refresh required
- “database ID” errors - Permission related errors resolved
- Uploading a paper to Zotero leads to the column in the SN Paper Library to say uploaded by “Notero” instead of the user. This is hardwired into Notion.
- The permissions of the Zotero library preventing the download of Notero resolved

Future Directions and Improvements

1. Using Zapier “zaps” for various functions.
   a. A zap that reflects edits in Notion to Zotero has already been completed. It does not utilize Notero. Right now it requires everyone to download the zap individually and I would like to avoid that.

2. Finding a way to put the uploaders name on the library, since right now it just says “Uploaded by Notero”.
3. Relational linking? By topic or author
4. Very open to suggestions!

Q&A

Prompt: “Diverse magical ocean life DNA Proteins Genes”